



Disappearing keys

Tactus is working on a touch-screen, android tablet that can provide true tactile feedback. <http://dgit.in/Kcm45U>

Nokia Maps go social

The new update from Nokia seems similar to Google Maps on social location, just like travelers can now add reviews and photos to locations. <http://dgit.in/Kx3q80>

Spend Smart!

Most people spend less than ₹10,000 on their very first smartphone, and we're here to decide exactly what model that should be...



Sameer Mitha

sameer.mitha@thinkdigit.com

In this app crazy world of ours, you don't own a phone unless you can tell what OS it's running. Android so-and-so for the masses, iOS something-or-the-other for the rich spoilt brats, bada for the ones who want to stand apart, Windows for many others... you get the drift. No one wants a dumb phone anymore, but not all of us are blessed with pockets deep enough to be able to spend any

more than ₹10K on a phone, and, guess what, you don't need to. Thanks to the opening up of the Indian phone market, all of us have a plethora of choices, and most of them are pretty good at what they do.

Obviously, in order to keep prices below ₹10,000, these devices need to compromise on a few features – but can you really blame them? Yes, you will not get cutting edge touch-screen quality, or an amazing camera, but what you will get is a feature-rich smart phone for a fraction of the price.

We received 8 devices. Three of these devices run on Google's popular Android OS, one on Samsung's bada OS, and three on Nokia's Symbian S40.

BATTLE OF THE OS: ANDROID VS BADA VS SYMBIAN

The sub ₹10,000 price point has spoiled the consumers in terms of the OS available. You have budget phones running Android, Symbian as well as proprietary OSes such as bada. The Android OS is essentially a smartphone OS giving users

access to a plethora of apps and functions. Customisation is the biggest feature of Android as it gives you access to widgets that you can use to populate your home screens. The Android devices usually have a skin to make the interface look different from the competition. If you don't like the pre-loaded skin, you can replace it by downloading one from the Google Play store. The Symbian S40 OS is ideal as a feature phone OS, but lacks the apps library that Android offers. The Bada OS has Samsung's